

April 16, 1988

ED JUGE
Director
Market Planning

Mr. Jim McBrian, Publisher
80 Micro Magazine
80 Elm Street
Peterborough, NH 03458

Dear Jim,

I am addressing this letter to you, but I do hope you'll share it with Mike, Buzzy, Mark, Dave, and all of the 80 staff.

It was very sad to hear that you will be closing down the third-oldest publication in the PC market. I'm sure it was a carefully considered decision, but that doesn't make it any easier to take. In my opinion, it is especially sad since the "new" staff was doing a wonderful job of pumping life and excitement into the book. Given a little time, you could returned 80 to the "winner" status it once enjoyed.

While Tandy compatibles, and HP compatibles, and Dell compatibles may be "just compatibles" to the "bean counters", they're much more to their owners. Users I talk to are easily bored with the constant "IBM...IBM...IBM" in general "PC magazines." A magazine is simply more interesting if everything in it is centered on your computer, and you don't have to wade through pages and pages dealing with computers you don't give a whit about. I truly believe most computer users feel this way. Unfortunately, they want to read product ads. Unfortunately, at today's ad rates, vendors can't advertise in 48 magazines every month. And that's your "bottom line."

Tandy and 80 have had our differences over the years, as any business associates are bound to have. I'm especially saddened because I am convinced that 80 would have been a smashing success, had the present management/editorial team had the reigns 3 or 4 years ago. And your readers -- our customers -- would have had a wonderful support vehicle.

I wish all of you the best, and thank you sincerely for your efforts. Apparently they were a needed breath of fresh air that just came a little too late.

Sincerely,

